1957. G. Evelyn Hutchinson establishes the concept of niche breadth at the Cold Spring Harbor Symposia on Quantitative Biology.

1960. Nelson Hairston, Frederick Smith, and Lawrence Slobodkin's "green world hypothesis" argues that the predator to prey balance is key to flourishing ecosystems.

1967. Robert MacArthur examines the biodiversity of isolated communities in The Theory of Island Biogeography.

1972. John Maynard Smith defines his Evolutionarily Stable Strategy (ESS) theory in On Evolution.

1973. Crawford Stanley Holling uses the term ecological resilience to show how ecological systems survive change.

1976. Hal Caswell proposes a "neutral" theory of biodiversity, suggesting that competitors are often equal, and chance plays the deciding role in what does or doesn't thrive.